1951

F

FAR EASTERN DEPARTMENT

JAPAN

FJ 1022/303

134

FROM

M. Tomkinson (Washington)

To

W. Johnston

No. 1076/ /51

Dated 18th April 1951.

Received in Registry— 21st April 1951

Enclosed article by Joseph Harsch which appeared in the Christian Science Monitor concerning United Government attitude towards Formosa in the pending J.P.T.

REFERENCES

MINUTES

AHM 26/4.

KPO 27/4.

China Dept.

American Dept. (U.S.)

1/5.

(Print)

(How disposed of)

(Action completed)

(Index)

29/6/51

1951

F

FAR EASTERN DEPARTMENT

JAPAN

FJ 1022/303

134

FROM

M. Jenkins (Washington)

To

M. Johnston

No. 1076/ /51

Dated 18th April 1951.

Received in Registry— 21st April 1951

Enclosed letter by Joseph Harsch which appeared in the Christian Science Monitor covering United States attitude towards Formosa in the pending J.P.T.

REFERENCES

MINUTES

Army 26/4.

China Dept. FRD 27/4.

American Dept. (U.S.).

1/5.

(Print)

(How disposed of)

(Action completed)

2/5

(Index)

29/6/51

39318

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE

Reference:-

FO 371/92543

COPYRIGHT - NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION

1. Mr. C.H. Scott
2. Enter

CONFIDENTIAL

1076/ /51

BRITISH EMBASSY
WASHINGTON

18th April 1951.

FJ 1022/303

My Dear Charles,

I think you will be interested to see the attached article by Joseph Harsch which appeared in yesterday's Christian Science Monitor. It is not accurate in every particular but from our point of view it is extremely helpful. Harsch's reference to "a score of angry attacks on the British" is a distinct under statement. The State Department official quoted in the last paragraph is of course John Allison. As soon as I read the article I spoke to Allison on the telephone and although he himself had not yet seen it he confirmed that he had recently spoken to Harsch on these lines.

Yours ever

Tommy

F.S. Tomlinson

C. H. Johnston, Esq.,
Japan and Pacific Department,
Foreign Office,
London S.W. 1

1. Dec. F.O. State
2. Letter

CONFIDENTIAL

1076/ /51

BRITISH EMBASSY
WASHINGTON

18th April 1951.

135

J 1022/303

My Dear Charles,

I think you will be interested to see the attached article by Joseph Harsch which appeared in yesterday's Christian Science Monitor. It is not accurate in every particular but from our point of view it is extremely helpful. Harsch's reference to "a score of angry attacks on the British" is a distinct under statement. The State Department official quoted in the last paragraph is of course John Allison. As soon as I read the article I spoke to Allison on the telephone and although he himself had not yet seen it he confirmed that he had recently spoken to Harsch on these lines.

Yours ever

Tommy

F.S. Tomlinson

C. H. Johnston, Esq.,
Japan and Pacific Department,
Foreign Office,
London S.W. 1

Reference:- FO 371/92543
PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
COPYRIGHT - NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION

NOTHING TO BE WRITTEN IN THIS MARGIN.

Minutes.

Christian Science Monitor

Tuesday 17th April 136

State of the Nation

Unnecessary Trouble

By JOSEPH C. HARSCH, Chief, Washington News Bureau, The Christian Science Monitor

Washington

The most unnecessary and untimely trouble stirred up in a long time is the report that the British Government is pressing for the gift of Formosa to Communist China in the pending Japanese Peace Treaty.

This alleged bit of information "broke" in the news the same day General MacArthur's relief from command in the Far Ea was announced. It was accepted immediately at face value in Congress. A score of angry attacks on Britain have resulted. The suspicion has gone around here that somehow the presumed British desire to "appease" China is linked with the MacArthur dismissal.

* * *

Color was lent the story by the State Department's treatment of it. On Friday last the official State Department spokesman denied that the United States would have any part in dealings with Communist China. The denial was phrased in a manner which seemed to accept the version that the British do wish to give Formosa to Communist China.

Considering there are a number of strains on Anglo-American relations and that a real breach between London and Washington would be more to the Kremlin's advantage than a great military triumph for Communist arms in Korea, this is the kind of disturbance which we could happily dispense with, particularly considering that the story isn't true, as the State Department now has declared.

Present evidence indicates that some individuals in the State Department have used the affair as a device for proving that the State Department is not "an annex of No. 10 Downing Street." No one can blame the State Department for wanting to get itself into as popular a position as possible in view of the unusual amount of abuse it has been absorbing of late. However, to rescue itself at the price of relations with our most important ally is a curious behaviorism at the department which has the primary task of protecting our alliances.

The truth of the matter is that there is almost no substantial difference between London and Washington on any part of the Japanese Peace Treaty problem relating to China and Formosa. There are sharp differences over remilitarization of Japan and the level of shipbuilding industry to be permitted to Japan, but on Formosa and China the plan worked out by John Foster Dulles is almost identical with the views of London.

* * *

It is true that the British have suggested that Communist China have a chance to sign the treaty. Mr. Dulles also would like to see Communist China sign the treaty —and so would the United States Department of Defense. If neither Russia nor China signs the treaty and we proceed to set up Japan as a sovereign country, the Russians and Chinese would have a legal basis for claiming that we had abandoned our responsibilities to occupy Japan. They might move in some night with their own armies as the residual occupiers under terms of the surrender document.

Mr. Dulles had intended to let the British, or the Japanese themselves, send the draft treaty to Peiping to see if perhaps the Chinese might sign. At least we would avoid the charge of trying to exclude the Chinese people from a voice in the treaty by offering a chance which they probably would reject anyway.

As to Formosa, both the Foreign Office in London and the State Department here have long recognized that Formosa can be used as a carrot in front of the donkey's nose. No one has the slightest idea of letting the Communist China donkey eat the Formosa carrot now, or at any immediately foreseeable stage in the future. But someday, perhaps, there will be a change in Peiping.

* * *

What the British want is a Formosa clause in the Japanese treaty which will preserve Formosa's status as a carrot for possible future use if and when the Chinese in Peiping begin to doubt the wisdom of tying China's destiny to Moscow. The State Department really goes along with that.

However, it's a bit difficult to explain to congressional and public opinion, and it's more popular to adopt a lofty and self-righteous attitude of indignation and let it be implied that the British are wickedly wanting to turn Formosa over today to Communist China.

One State Department official commented wryly on the whole episode:

"Some of our amateurs around here haven't been in diplomacy long enough to know that a British Foreign Office statement is a beginning for discussion, not an ultimatum. They were looking for a British ultimatum they could stand up against in a grandstand play of anti-Britishism. They thought they saw their chance."

MAY 26 :
H GRAVES
CHANCERY
3100 MA:
WASHING

Minutes.

Christian Science Monitor

Tuesday 17th April 135

State of the Nation

Unnecessary Trouble

By JOSEPH C. HARSCH, Chief, Washington News Bureau, The Christian Science Monitor

Washington

The most unnecessary and untimely trouble stirred up in a long time is the report that the British Government is pressing for the gift of Formosa to Communist China in the pending Japanese Peace Treaty.

This alleged bit of information "broke" in the news the same day General MacArthur's relief from command in the Far Ea was announced. It was accepted immediately at face value in Congress. A score of angry attacks on Britain have resulted. The suspicion has gone around here that somehow the presumed British desire to "appease" China is linked with the MacArthur dismissal.

* * *

Color was lent the story by the State Department's treatment of it. On Friday last the official State Department spokesman denied that the United States would have any part in dealings with Communist China. The denial was phrased in a manner which seemed to accept the version that the British do wish to give Formosa to Communist China.

Considering there are a number of strains on Anglo-American relations and that a real breach between London and Washington would be more to the Kremlin's advantage than a great military triumph for Communist arms in Korea, this is the kind of disturbance which we could happily dispense with, particularly considering that the story isn't true, as the State Department now has declared.

Present evidence indicates that some individuals in the State Department have used the affair as a device for proving that the State Department is not "an annex of No. 10 Downing Street." No one can blame the State Department for wanting to get itself into as popular a position as possible in view of the unusual amount of abuse it has been absorbing of late. However, to rescue itself at the price of relations with our most important ally is a curious behaviorism at the department which has the primary task of protecting our alliances.

The truth of the matter is that there is almost no substantial difference between London and Washington on any part of the Japanese Peace Treaty problem relating to China and Formosa. There are sharp differences over remilitarization of Japan and the level of shipbuilding industry to be permitted to Japan, but on Formosa and China the plan worked out by John Foster Dulles is almost identical with the views of London.

* * *

It is true that the British have suggested that Communist China have a chance to sign the treaty. Mr. Dulles also would like to see Communist China sign the treaty —and so would the United States Department of Defense. If neither Russia nor China signs the treaty and we proceed to set up Japan as a sovereign country, the Russians and Chinese would have a legal basis for claiming that we had abandoned our responsibilities to occupy Japan. They might move in some night with their own armies as the residual occupiers under terms of the surrender document.

Mr. Dulles had intended to let the British, or the Japanese themselves, send the draft treaty to Peiping to see if perhaps the Chinese might sign. At least we would avoid the charge of trying to exclude the Chinese people from a voice in the treaty by offering a chance which they probably would reject anyway.

As to Formosa, both the Foreign Office in London and the State Department here have long recognized that Formosa can be used as a carrot in front of the donkey's nose. No one has the slightest idea of letting the Communist China donkey eat the Formosa carrot now, or at any immediately foreseeable stage in the future. But someday, perhaps, there will be a change in Peiping.

* * *

What the British want is a Formosa clause in the Japanese treaty which will preserve Formosa's status as a carrot for possible future use if and when the Chinese in Peiping begin to doubt the wisdom of tying China's destiny to Moscow. The State Department really goes along with that.

However, it's a bit difficult to explain to congressional and public opinion, and it's more popular to adopt a lofty and self-righteous attitude of indignation and let it be implied that the British are wickedly wanting to turn Formosa over today to Communist China.

One State Department official commented wryly on the whole episode:

"Some of our amateurs around here haven't been in diplomacy long enough to know that a British Foreign Office statement is a beginning for discussion, not an ultimatum. They were looking for a British ultimatum they could stand up against in a grandstand play of anti-Britishism. They thought they saw their chance."

NOTHING TO BE WRITTEN IN THIS MARGIN.

MAY 26
H GRAVE
CHANCER
3100 MA
WASHING

FO 371/92543
PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
COPYRIGHT - NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION